



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Satellite and Connected Aircraft Cyber Dependency Exposure Report

Threat Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Satellite and Connected Aircraft Cyber Dependency Exposure Report - Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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Satellite and Connected Aircraft Cyber Dependency Exposure Report

1. Executive Summary

Aviation increasingly depends on satellite communications, connected aircraft services, ground stations, and space-enabled data. Public satellite-cybersecurity reporting and policy activity emphasize that distributed space systems need monitoring and resilience beyond traditional perimeter controls.

2. Coverage Window Note

The aviation/aerospace daily section prioritized the last 24-72 hours first. Because fewer than five corroborated, sector-specific public items were available in that window, this report intentionally expands to a recent/standing sector-relevant source set and labels trend-level or strategic exposure claims accordingly.

3. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answer in This Report
What happened?	Public reporting and policy discussions highlight satellite cybersecurity, space-system intrusion detection, and connected-aviation dependency risk.
Who is affected?	Airlines, business aviation, satellite service providers, airports, defense aviation, and connected-aircraft suppliers.
What should defenders do?	Map satcom and connected-aircraft dependencies, review provider security obligations, and add anomaly monitoring to ground/enterprise integration points.
Confidence	Medium; this is strategic exposure analysis using public sector sources rather than a single active incident.

4. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
IATA Aviation Cyber Security	Aviation cybersecurity priority context	Medium
SecurityWeek satellite cybersecurity policy coverage	Satellite cybersecurity policy/risk context	Medium
Globals satellite cybersecurity overview	Space-system threat and monitoring context	Medium

5. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

The most practical defensive focus is the terrestrial integration layer: identity, management portals, APIs, ground stations, and data feeds that connect aircraft, operations centers, and satellite providers.

6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic	Technique / Behavior	Defensive Interpretation
Initial Access	Provider portal/API compromise	Enforce MFA and least privilege on satellite service portals.
Collection	Telemetry/data-feed access	Monitor abnormal downloads and API

		usage.
Impact	Service degradation or data integrity issues	Prepare alternate communication and operational procedures.

7. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Signal	Notes
Behavior	Source did not publish stable atomic IOCs	Hunt on process, network, identity, and SaaS behaviors.

Hard IOCs are limited where primary sources did not publish stable indicators. Treat behavior, infrastructure class, and telemetry pivots as the primary hunting path until local intelligence enrichment identifies environment-specific indicators.

8. Victimology and Targeting

Operators with satellite-dependent navigation, communications, weather, tracking, or passenger connectivity workflows.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Suspicious script or LOLBin execution	Endpoint process telemetry	Surface initial execution and staging activity
New external connection after lure/app execution	Network telemetry	Identify callback or payload retrieval
Unusual account, mailbox, or SaaS activity	Identity/SaaS audit logs	Detect credential abuse and persistence

9.2. Sigma / Detection Rule

```

title: Suspicious Script and Remote Tool Activity - satellite-connected-aircraft-cyber-depen
status: experimental
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_tools:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  selection_suspicious:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - 'http'
      - 'download'
      - 'EncodedCommand'
      - 'Invoke-Expression'
  condition: selection_tools and selection_suspicious
level: high

```

9.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "wscript.exe", "cscript.exe", "mshta.exe", "rundll32.exe",
"node.exe", "osascript")

```

```
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("http", "download", "EncodedCommand", "Invoke-Expression", "curl",
"wget")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName
```

10. Threat Hunting

10.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
Initial access used lure-driven script, package, or web exploitation behavior.	Correlate suspicious process launches with browser, archive, package-manager, or web-server parents.
Follow-on access used identity or remote-management tooling.	Review new OAuth grants, administrative changes, RMM agents, and rare remote endpoints.

10.2. Network Hunt Query

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName has_any ("powershell.exe", "node.exe", "python.exe", "osascript",
"curl", "wget")
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteIP
| order by Connections desc
```

11. Risk Assessment

Risk Area	Assessment	Rationale
Initial Access	Elevated	Recent reporting indicates active or plausible attacker interest.
Credential Exposure	Medium-High	Many campaigns convert endpoint access into identity abuse.
Operational Disruption	Medium	Impact depends on privilege, sector, and dependency concentration.

12. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

Sector Segment	Operational Relevance	Exposure Path	Defender Action
Airlines/business aviation	Connectivity, tracking, and passenger services depend on providers	Satcom portals/APIs, onboard connectivity management	Provider due diligence and operational fallback plans
Airports/operations centers	Data feeds support coordination and weather/flight awareness	Ground integrations	Monitor API usage and data integrity
Satellite/space providers	Service disruption can cascade to aviation customers	Ground stations, control systems, supplier access	Segment control planes and test incident response

Aviation/aerospace operators should assess not only direct enterprise compromise but also third-party concentration: airport common-use platforms, MRO vendors, satellite connectivity providers, identity providers, reservation systems, engineering PLM, and managed service providers can all become operational chokepoints.

13. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
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High	SOC	Deploy hunts in this report and tune to local telemetry.
High	IT/security engineering	Patch exposed systems, verify EDR coverage, and restrict script interpreters where possible.
Medium	Identity team	Review new privileged accounts, OAuth grants, and risky sign-ins for the lookback period.
Medium	Threat intel	Track source updates for IOCs, exploit details, and sector-specific victimology.

14. References

- [1] IATA Aviation Cyber Security — <https://www.iata.org/en/programs/security/cyber-security/>
- [2] SecurityWeek satellite cybersecurity policy coverage — <https://www.securityweek.com/in-other-news-satellite-cybersecurity-act-90k-chrome-flaw-teen-hacker-arrested/>
- [3] Globals satellite cybersecurity overview — <https://www.globalsinc.com/cybersecurity-in-space-protecting-satellites-from-modern-cyber-threats/>